

ART AND CULTURE



LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

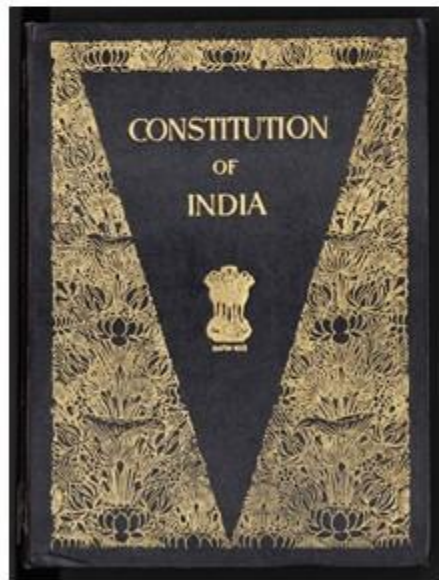
- OFFICIAL LANGUAGE
- CLASSICAL LANGUAGE STATUS
- LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY INDEX

MODULE – 2



OFFICIAL LANGUAGES OF INDIA

हिन्दी



- 1 Article 343 (1) of the constitution of India states that "The Official Language of the Union Government shall be **Hindi in Devanagari Script**".
- 2 "Unless Parliament decided otherwise, the **use of English** for official purposes was to cease 15 years after the Constitution came into effect", i.e on 26 January 1965.
- 3 It means over a period of fifteen years since the commencement of the Indian Constitution, **Hindi will replace English as the Official language**. However, Parliament can decide whether to use English as the official language or not.

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES OF INDIA



- 4 This led to protest across the nation by the non-Hindi speaking communities against the change in official language from English to Hindi.

- 5 The protest resulted in the enactment of the **Official Language Act, 1963**.
- 6 Thus, Hindi and English continue to be used for the official communication in the Central Government and for communication between the Centre and the States.
- 7 English has been given the status of “Subsidiary Official language” of the union.
- 8 The Constitution of India made a provision for each of the Indian States to choose their own official language for communications at the State level.

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES OF INDIA

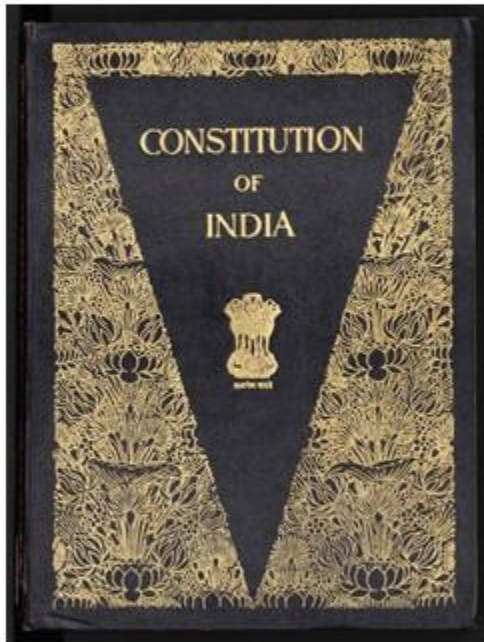
9 There are many languages listed in the **Eighth Schedule of the Constitution** which may be used by the States for the official purpose.



10 Initially 14 languages were selected under Eighth Schedule. They were.

- 1) Assamese
- 2) Hindi
- 3) Malayalam
- 4) Punjabi
- 5) Telugu
- 6) Bengali
- 7) Kannada
- 8) Marathi
- 9) Sanskrit
- 10) Urdu
- 11) Gujarati
- 12) Kashmiri
- 13) Odia
- 14) Tamil

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES OF INDIA



- 11** Later **Sindhi** was added as the 15th language through 21st Amendment Act of 1967.
- 12** Three more languages were added by 71st Amendment act, 1992. They are **Konkani, Manipuri, and Nepali**.
- 13** 92nd Amendment Act, 2003 added four more languages to the Eighth Schedule. They are Bodo, Maithili, Dogri and Santhali.
- 14** At present, there are 22 languages in total listed under the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution.

हिंदी

~~National Language~~
Official Language
of India

IMPORTANT NOTES

- *There is no national language of India. Hindi is not a national language. Neither does the Constitution nor any Act define the National Language*
- *The Constitution does not specify the official language to be used by the States for the conduct of official function. States are free to adopt it.*
- *The language to be adopted by the States need not be one of those listed in the Eighth Schedule and several States have adopted official language which are not listed.*
Example:
 - *Tripura- Kokborok*
 - *Puducherry- French*
 - *Mizoram- Mizo*
- *English is the official language of Nagaland and Meghalaya.*
- *English is not in the list of 22 Scheduled Language as per Eighth Schedule.*

STATUS OF CLASSICAL LANGUAGE

CRITERIA

In 2004, the Government of India declared that languages that meet certain requirements could be accorded the status of “Classical Language in India”.



1

The following criteria were laid down to determine the eligibility of languages to be considered for classification as a “Classical Language”.

- High antiquity of its early texts/recorded history over a period of 1500-2000 years.
- A body of ancient literature/texts, which is considered a valuable heritage by generations of speakers.
- The literary tradition be original and not borrowed from another speech community.
- Also, since the classical language and literature being distinct from modern, there may also be a discontinuity between the classical language and its later forms or its offshoots.

STATUS OF CLASSICAL LANGUAGE

CRITERIA

தமிழ் tamil 2004

संस्कृतम् sanskrit 2005

ಕನ್ನಡ kannada 2008

తెలుగు telugu 2008

മലയാളം malayalam 2013

ଓଡ଼ିଆ oriya 2014

2 Languages so far declared to be Classical Language are:

- Tamil in the year 2004
- Sanskrit in the year 2005
- Telugu in the year 2008
- Kannada in the year 2008
- Malayalam in the year 2013
- Odia in the year 2014

3 The Government has been criticized for not including Pali as a classical language as experts argue that it fits all the above mentioned criteria.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

STATUS OF CLASSICAL LANGUAGE

BENEFITS

Government of India's resolution states that the following benefits will accrue to a language declared as a "Classical Language"



1 Once a language is declared classical, it gets financial assistance for setting up a centre of excellence for the study of that language.

2 Two major awards for scholars of eminence in Classical Indian Languages to be awarded annually.

3 A "Centre of Excellence for Studies in Classical Languages" will be set up.

4 The University Grants Commission will be requested to create and to start with at least in the Central Universities, a certain number of Professional Chairs for Classical Languages for Scholars of eminence in Classical Indian Languages.

NATIONAL TRANSLATION MISSION



राष्ट्रीय अनुवाद मिशन
National Translation Mission



- 1 National Translation Mission (NTM) is a Government of India scheme to facilitate higher education by making knowledge texts accessible to students and academics in Indian languages.
- 2 NTM aims to disseminate knowledge in all Indian languages listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution through translation.
- 3 A combination of efforts is made to orient translators, encourage publishers to publish translations, maintain databases of published translations from, into and between Indian languages and to become a clearing house of information on translation to establish translation as an industry in India.

NATIONAL TRANSLATION MISSION

- 4 It is expected to **facilitate the modernization of languages** by developing new terminologies and discourse styles through translation.
- 5 Knowledge translation is the first step towards the goal of establishing translation as an industry.



- 6 All **textual materials** meant for the dissemination of knowledge constitute the corpus of knowledge texts for NTM.
- 7 At present, NTM is engaged in the **translation of all pedagogic materials related to higher education** in 22 Indian languages
- 8 NTM aims to open up the vast body of knowledge by translating the high education texts, available mostly in English, into Indian languages.
- 9 It is expected that this will eventually pave the way for the **constitution of an inclusive knowledge society**.

OBJECTIVES OF THE NTM

- 1 Certification and training of translators in different areas.
- 2 Generation and maintenance of databases.
- 3 Conducting short-term orientation courses under the Translator Education Programme.
- 4 Promotion of machine aided translation between English and Indian languages.
- 5 Development of translation tools such as dictionaries and thesauri.
- 6 Offer fellowships and grants for Natural Language Processing and translation related research projects.
- 7 Promote visibility to translators and translation activities by organizing events like book launches for translations, regional translation festivals, discussions, book exhibitions etc.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY INDEX

- 1** Linguistic Diversity Index (LDI) is the probability that two people selected from the population at random will have different mother tongue.
- 2** It therefore, ranges from 0 (everyone has the same mother tongue) to 1 (no two people have the same mother tongue).
- 3** The Linguistic Diversity Index can provide insight into the multicultural nature of countries.
- 4** Some have high linguistic diversity because of their geographic position along trade routes. This is seen in the relatively high linguistic diversity in Kazakhstan, which was part of the Silk Road.
- 5** Other countries have high linguistic diversity due to the presence of multiple, distinct ethnic groups, as seen in Bolivia, India, and Chad.
- 6** Nations with low levels of linguistic diversity, such as Japan and Norway, are often culturally homogeneous.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY INDEX

- 7 The computation of the diversity index is based on the **population of each language as a proportion of the total population**.
- 8 The index cannot fully account for the vitality of languages.
- 9 Also, the distinction between a language and dialect is fluid and often political.
- 10 A great number of languages are considered to be dialects of another language by some experts and separate languages by others.
- 11 The **index does not consider how different the languages are from each other**, nor does it account for second language usage, it considers only the total number of distinct languages and their relative frequency as **mother tongues**.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

LINGUA FRANCA



- 1 A Lingua Franca also known as **Bridge Language**, common language, trade language, is a language or dialect systematically used to make **communication possible between persons not sharing a native language or dialect**, in particular when it is a third language, distinct from both native languages.
- 2 Lingua Franca have developed around the world throughout human history, **sometimes for commercial reasons but also for cultural, religious, diplomatic and administrative convenience** and as a means of exchanging information between scientists and other scholars of different nationalities

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